



Portugal — Bilateral Overview (Switzerland focus)

Macroeconomic outlook and Swiss–Portugal services relationship, 2015–2027 (latest actuals through 2024; IMF forecasts to 2027 where available)

Task Bilateral Overview

Countries PRT

Question Portugal

Executive Summary

Portugal presents a broadly predictable macroeconomic environment: growth is moderating from recent highs, inflation has eased markedly since 2022, and public debt is on a declining trajectory. For Switzerland, the most salient quantified bilateral signal in the evidence pack is services trade: Swiss services exports to Portugal have risen since 2019, but Swiss services imports from Portugal remain substantially higher, indicating a persistent services trade deficit on the WTO “balanced values” series. Engagement priorities may therefore centre on identifying market openings for Swiss high-value services and addressing practical barriers affecting Swiss providers, while continuing to monitor Portugal’s improving fiscal position and near-term inflation dynamics.

Key Points

- Macro conditions are stable with moderating growth: real GDP growth was 2.2% in 2024; IMF forecasts around 1.8–1.9% in 2026–2027.
- Disinflation supports predictability for business planning: CPI inflation fell to 2.7% in 2024 after the 2022 peak; IMF forecasts remain in the low single digits through 2027.
- Public debt remains elevated but is improving: gross government debt declined to 93.5% of GDP in 2024 and is forecast to fall further by 2027.

- Swiss–Portugal services trade is sizeable and rising, but imbalanced: in 2024 Switzerland imported more services from Portugal than it exported (WTO balanced values).

Headline Metrics

REAL GDP GROWTH (PORTUGAL)

2.2% (2024)

IMF DataMapper; forecast 1.9% (2026) and 1.8% (2027).

CPI INFLATION (PORTUGAL)

2.7% (2024)

IMF DataMapper; forecast 3.1% (2026) and 2.3% (2027).

UNEMPLOYMENT RATE (PORTUGAL)

6.5% (2024)

IMF DataMapper; forecast 5.9% (2026–2027).

GROSS GOVERNMENT DEBT (PORTUGAL)

93.5% of GDP (2024)

IMF DataMapper; down from 134.1% (2020) and forecast 82.2% (2027).

SWISS SERVICES EXPORTS TO PORTUGAL

US\$ 679m (2024)

WTO Timeseries API; balanced values; up from US\$ 474m (2019).

SWISS SERVICES IMPORTS FROM PORTUGAL

US\$ 1,649m (2024)

WTO Timeseries API; balanced values; up from US\$ 1,057m (2019).

Macroeconomic snapshot and outlook

Portugal combines steady growth with improving macro stability. Real GDP growth reached **2.2% in 2024**, with IMF forecasts indicating a moderation to around **1.8–1.9%** by **2026–2027**. Inflation has eased substantially since the 2022 spike, reaching **2.7% in 2024**; the IMF baseline keeps inflation in the low single digits through 2027.

Labour market conditions are relatively stable, with unemployment at **6.5% in 2024** and a forecast improvement to **5.9%** by **2026–2027**.

Nominal GDP was **US\$ 313.6bn** in 2024 and GDP per capita **US\$ 29,319**, consistent with an upper-middle/high-income European partner profile relevant for Swiss commercial engagement.

Fiscal trajectory and sovereign risk considerations

Portugal's public debt remains high in level but is on a clear downward path. Gross government debt fell from **134.1% of GDP (2020)** to **93.5% (2024)**, with IMF projections to **82.2%** by **2027**. For Swiss stakeholders, this trajectory can reduce perceived sovereign-risk concerns over time, supporting a generally predictable operating environment; however, the debt level remains a constraint to watch in adverse scenarios.

Swiss–Portugal services relationship (WTO balanced values)

The evidence pack captures the bilateral relationship primarily through services trade. Swiss **services exports to Portugal** increased from **US\$ 474m (2019)** to **US\$ 679m (2024)**. Over the same period, Swiss **services imports from Portugal** rose more sharply, from **US\$ 1,057m (2019)** to **US\$ 1,649m (2024)**.

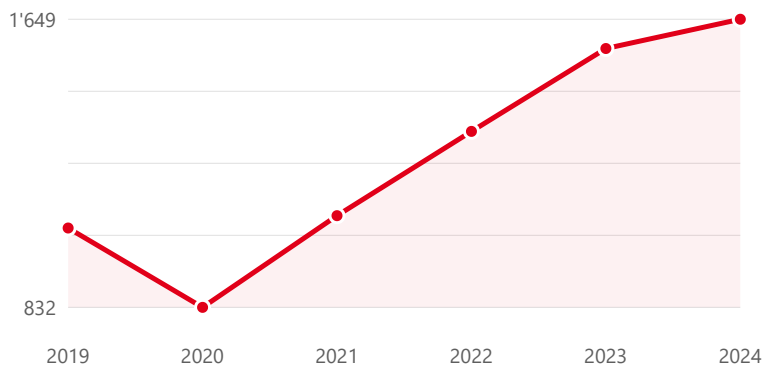
Imports exceed exports in each reported year (2019–2024), indicating a persistent Swiss services trade deficit vis-à-vis Portugal on this series. From a Switzerland-facing perspective, this points to practical engagement angles: identifying sectors where Swiss service providers can expand, promoting competitiveness in high-value services, and addressing barriers to

market access and delivery (noting that the pack does not provide sectoral breakdowns).

EVIDENCE VISUALS

Trend: Portugal - Services imports: balanced values

Automatically selected because the evidence includes a consistent multi-year time series. — Million US dollar



DATA CAVEATS

- Swiss National Bank bilateral FDI indicators (fdiausbla_stock, fdiausbla_share) are missing in the evidence pack, limiting assessment of Swiss investment exposure in Portugal.
- IMF services indicators in the pack (bopserva_total; bopserva_share is missing) are null/unavailable; the briefing relies on WTO services indicators reported as “balanced values” in million US dollars.
- WTO services series are only available for 2019–2024 in the pack; no 2025–2027 bilateral services values are provided.
- World Bank GNI per capita (Atlas method) is available only through 2024 in the pack; no 2025–2027 values are provided.

AIDA — AI Diplomatic Assistant



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